

Light

Light is a form of energy that our eyes can detect. It comes in all the colors of the rainbow, but when the colors are mixed together, light is white.



Fireflies

Some animals create their own light. Fireflies flash a yellowish-green color from their abdomens at night to attract mates.

Where does light come from?

Light is produced by electrically charged particles in atoms—especially negatively charged electrons.

Candlelight is produced by hot atoms in tiny particles of soot inside the flame.

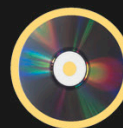
Casting shadows

Light can only travel in straight lines. If something blocks its path, it casts a shadow—a dark area that the light cannot reach.



Using light

We can use light for many different things.



CDs and DVDs store digital information that can be read by laser beam.



Cameras capture light in a split second to create photographs.



Telescopes collect the light from stars and planets, and produce magnified images of them.



Mirrors reflect light so we can see images of ourselves.



Periscopes bend the path of light so we can see around corners.



Flashlights shine a beam of light to help us see in the dark.